

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10  
 ♥ K J 8 3 2  
 ♦ A 5 4 2  
 ♣ 9 7 4

♠ A Q 8 7 5 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 3

♣ A 6 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ J 3  
 ♥ A 9 6 5  
 ♦ J 10 8 7  
 ♣ Q 8 5

♠ K 9 6 4

♥ Q 7

♦ K Q 6

♣ K J 10 3

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1 ♣   |
| Pass         | 1 ♠   | Pass | 2 ♠   |
| Pass         | 4 ♠   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 4 ♠ by North |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ J    |       |      |       |

North is to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♦ J, covered by the ♦ Q and ♦ A. West returns a ♦ to the ♦ K.

You still have two losers in the ♥ suit, so the question is which way you plan to finesse the ♣s. And of course the answer is that you don't plan to finesse them at all!

Pull trumps with the ♠ A, then ♠ K. Next ruff dummy's last ♦.

Now exit with a ♥. The defenders win this and take another ♥ trick, leaving this position.

They must now break the ♣ suit for you or give you a ruff-sluff. Of course you would ruff in dummy and discard a ♣ from the 3-card holding in your hand.

If West is the one who has to play a ♣ you just let it ride around to dummy's ♣ K J 10 3.

If East is the one who has to play a ♣ you need to insert the ♣ 10 or ♣ J from dummy.

In either case you will no longer have a ♣ loser.

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 6 4 3 2

♥ K 5 2

♦ K 8

♣ K 10 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ Q 10 7 6

♦ 10 5 2

♣ 9 6 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A K 8 7 5

♥ A 4

♦ A 6 3

♣ A J 7

♠ -

♥ J 9 8 3

♦ Q J 9 7 4

♣ Q 8 5 3

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

Pass

6 ♠

All Pass

6 ♠ by East

Lead: ♦ Q

West decides a limit raise is better than just jumping to game. East has heard enough and bids the slam.

East is to play 6 ♠. South leads the ♦ Q.

Your first thought is probably that if you can guess the ♣ Q you will make all thirteen tricks.

So you win the ♦ K and play a ♠ to your ♠ K. When South discards a ♦ your second thought is probably that you **MUST** guess the ♣ Q just to make twelve tricks.

Hopefully your third thought is that if you use an elimination play you won't have to guess.

Play your ♠ A, leaving North with the master ♠ Q. Then eliminate ♦ s by playing ♦ A and ruffing a ♦ in dummy.

Now eliminate ♥ s by playing ♥ A, ♥ K, and ruffing a ♥.

You are ready for the throw-in. Play a ♠ to North's ♠ Q.

[showcards N:ST,CK,CT,C2 S:S8,CA,CJ,C7]

North has just taken the defender's first trick. First and only. Because if he now plays a red card you will ruff in one hand and discard a losing ♣ from the other. And if he plays a ♣ you will no longer have a ♣ loser.

Most elimination plays work on the same principle. The biggest difference is usually the technique you have to use to complete the eliminations.

Here it took two ruffs, one in each hand.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 9 4 2

♥ 5

♦ Q 8 2

♣ 9 6 5 3

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q 10 8 2

♦ K 9 5

♣ K 10 2



♠ A 7 6

♥ 9 7 3

♦ 10 6 4 3

♣ Q 8 7

♠ J 10 5

♥ A J 6 4

♦ A J 7

♣ A J 4

| West     | North | East | South |
|----------|-------|------|-------|
|          |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass     | 2♦    | Pass | 2♥    |
| Pass     | 3NT   | Pass | 4♥    |
| All Pass |       |      |       |

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠K  
be happy about it, though.

[showcards N:H8,CK,CT,C2 S:HJ,CA,CJ,C4]

Whichever defender wins the ♦Q is end-played. If he plays a ♦ or a ♠ you will ruff in one hand and discard a ♣ loser from the other. But if he leads a ♣ instead you no longer have a ♣ loser.

On this Deal an elimination play will guarantee that you make your contract.

However, it also guarantees that you will not make an overtrick.

If you try the two finesses instead you **MIGHT** make an overtrick, but you also might go down 1.

Decide for yourself!

North first transfers you to ♥s, then gives you a choice of which game to play. Knowing you have an 9-card trump fit, you choose 4♥.

South is to play 4♥. The defenders start with ♠K, ♠Q, ♠A.

In addition to the two ♠s already lost you have a potential loser in each minor suit. On the plus side, you have a finesse position in ♦s and a two-way finesse in ♣s. If you work both finesses successfully you make an overtrick - if both fail you will be down 1. Or, you could try for a 100% sure end-play.

Ruff the ♠A with dummy's ♥10 and pull trumps (three rounds).

Eliminate ♦s by playing ♦K, ♦A, ♦J. If you are REALLY lucky the ♦Q will fall doubleton, but more than likely a defender will win the third ♦. He won't

**Board 4**

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 8 6 2  
♥ J 3  
♦ J 10 6 5  
♣ 7 6 4 3

♠ Q J 10 5 3

♥ Q 8 7 2

♦ 3

♣ J 8 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A

♥ A K 6

♦ A K Q 9 7 4

♣ A Q 9

♠ K 9 7 4

♥ 10 9 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ K 10 2

| West | North | East | South |
|------|-------|------|-------|
| 2♦   | Pass  | 2♣   | Pass  |
| 4♦   | Pass  | 3♦   | Pass  |
| 6♦   |       | 6♦   |       |

All Pass

6♦ by West

Lead: ♠Q

hand and play dummy's ♣9 if North plays low. South will win the trick but will be end-played, forced to either play a ♣ back to dummy's ♣A Q, or give you a ruff-sluff.

If North puts on either the ♣10 or ♣J you play dummy's ♣Q. If South can win with the ♣K he will once again be end-played, forced to either play a ♣ back to dummy's ♣A 9, or give you a ruff-sluff.

The A Q 9 combination is interesting. Obviously if you have A Q 10 it works very well in an end-play situation.

As you see, A Q 9 actually works just as well.

You naturally respond 2♦ to East's strong 2♣ opener. Before you know it you are playing a slam - with your mighty 2-point hand! West plays 6♦. North leads the ♠Q.

If the contract appears to depend upon a finesse, try to find another way. Here, you can always try the ♣ finesse, but maybe you can eliminate ♠s and see what happens.

Win the ♠A, play the ♦4 to the ♦10, and ruff a ♠ with the ♦Q. Both opponents followed to the trump.

Play the ♦7 to the ♦J and ruff the last ♠ with the ♦K.

Having eliminated the ♦s and ♠s, now remove the ♥s. Play ♥A, ♥K, and ruff a ♥.

At last it is time to play ♣s. Lead a ♣ from your hand and play dummy's ♣9 if North plays low. South will win the trick but will be end-played, forced to either play a ♣ back to dummy's ♣A Q, or give you a ruff-sluff.